EXECUTIVE AI BRIEFING / INVESTMENT DECISIONS

AI ROI: PROOF BEFORE SCALE

Seven measurement lenses. One disciplined financial decision.

01 | THE FULL INVESTMENT

COST API and tokens • infrastructure • licences • build and maintenance • people • controls • change and training

Include the complete cost across the same measurement period.

02 | MEASURABLE BUSINESS EFFECTS

Only verified financial effects enter the ROI numerator.

PRODUCTIVITY

Hours saved • cases per employee • cycle time

Count savings only when cost falls, hiring is avoided or capacity has evidenced economic use.

QUALITY

Accuracy • rework • error rate • customer outcomes

Value lower repair cost, fewer claims or measurable margin effects; do not count the same saving twice.

REVENUE

Conversion • retention • upsell • new AI offerings

Use incremental contribution margin, not gross revenue or pipeline estimates.

RISK REDUCTION

Compliance events • fraud • errors • security

Use defensible expected-loss reduction, adjusted for likelihood, impact and control cost.

03 | SIGNALS THAT SUPPORT THE DECISION

Track them carefully. Do not price them as cash without evidence.

ADOPTION

Active users • usage depth • workflow coverage

A leading signal of reach and use, not a financial return.

STRATEGIC VALUE

Time-to-market • decision speed • growth capacity

Record options and milestones; monetize only realized effects.

THE EVIDENCE CHAIN

BASELINE Before vs. after › **ATTRIBUTION** Against a credible alternative › **REALIZATION** Verified financial effect › **TOTAL COST** Same period and scope

NET ROI = **(Attributable financial benefit − full AI cost) ÷ full AI cost × 100**

Decision: SCALE with verified evidence / REDESIGN uncertain value / STOP persistent underperformance



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Enterprise AI Adoption • Governance • Business Transformation